



BHAWAN SINGH

Change of Pitch

It was love at "first grope" between "busty star" Zeenat Aman and Pakistani all-rounder Imran Khan. The year was 1980 and the union was doomed, *INDIA TODAY* predicted, because Imran wanted to stay in Pakistan where he "has to support a mother and several sisters" and Aman was too much in love with her career.



HEMANT CHAWLA

BARE AND BEAUTIFUL



Much before it became a full-time profession, Protima Bedi had perfected the knack of "being in the news for no particular reason," said *INDIA TODAY* in 1977. "Even when she shed every bit of clothing and streaked across Juhu Beach, onlookers merely smiled at Protima exercising." *Eyecatchers* chronicled her discovery of Odissi, the setting up of Nrityagram near Bangalore in 1990 and her often outrageous comments. Sample this on ex-husband Kabir Bedi and then love Parveen Babi: "They really suit, just like brothers and sisters. Their brownish hair, their western touch."



C. RAMESH

“They really suit, just like brothers and sisters.”

”

PROTIMA BEDI, ACTOR, 1977



REUBEN SINGH



Woman in White

Whether it was going topless in *Siddhartha*, marrying a businessman in Delhi, or fitting into her *Karz* role of Kamini like one of the iconic gowns she wore, Simi Garewal purred and cooed her way through *INDIA TODAY* pages, sometimes with a documentary on Rajiv Gandhi, at other times with a dipped-in-saccharine chat show. In 1976, her one desire was to be directed by David Lean. In 1997, it was to rendezvous with famous people. All in white, of course.

The Tina Factor



In 1977, she was a fresh-faced ingénue, Dev Anand's discovery in *Des Pardes*, prancing around London in her flimsy sari with the "nervousness of a young bride". In 1996, she was an art entrepreneur and wife of Reliance scion Anil Ambani, saying "movies made me what I am but you have to grow". In 2008, she was one of two Indians to make it to *Forbes'* list of Wives of Billionaires, being described by the magazine as being famous of her own accord. And yes, quite eyecatching.



FOTOCORP

